Project Proposal and Progression Reflection

My original proposal, *Echoes of the Forgotten*, was a low-poly 3D platformer featuring three levels, platforming mechanics, and a connected story. I planned to demonstrate computer graphics concepts through 3D environments, materials, lighting, animation, and visual effects.

During development, I changed my project to *Forest_Game*, a 3D forest exploration game that I was already developing for another course, GDW 3. I decided to adapt this existing project rather than start an entirely new game, allowing me to focus more time on implementing and demonstrating the computer graphics techniques required for this course. I contacted the professor and TA about the change but did not receive a response before proceeding.

What Worked

The new project gave me an opportunity to explore lighting and shaders in a practical environment. I implemented diffuse, ambient, specular, and combined lighting modes using Unity Shader Graph. I also created two custom outline shaders: a blue outline around the radio to communicate that it is interactable, and a cyan outline around tree leaves to add visual emphasis to the foliage. These implementations helped me understand how graphics techniques can improve both gameplay readability and visual presentation.

What Did Not work

I also began experimenting with LUT-based colour grading but was unable to complete it. I could not figure out how to implement it using shader graphs. I was able to edit the image in Photos though.This showed me that some graphics features require more time and troubleshooting than expected.